

AN TOBAR – INVITATION TO TENDER FOR CREATION OF AN EDUCATIONAL WEBSITE TO AID THE TEACHING OF IRISH IN ENGLISH-MEDIUM PRIMARY AND POST-PRIMARY SCHOOLS

July 20th 2026

INFORMATION

1. Tenders

An Chomhairle um Oideachas Gaeltachta (COGG) invites responses ("Tenders") to this Request for Tenders ("RFT") from economic operators ("Tenderers") for the provision of the services as described in Appendix 1 to this RFT, "Requirements and Specifications", ("the Services"). COGG is the contracting authority for this public procurement competition ("COGG").

2. About COGG

COGG is an aegis body of the Department of Education and Youth, with responsibility for Irish medium education at both primary and post-primary as well as the teaching of Irish in English-medium primary and post-primary schools. The organisation has a staff of 22 and are based in Dublin, Kerry, Monaghan, Galway, Meath, Donegal and Mayo. The organization has recently been tasked with enacting various elements of the [Action Plan for Irish in English Medium Schools](#). As part of this action plan COGG will create a website which will house resources and information to support schools, teachers, parents/guardians and students in the teaching and learning of Irish in English-medium schools. A team of five (Project Manager, 2 x Primary Education Officers, 2 x Post-Primary Education Officers) have been seconded from schools for two years to this end. Further information can be obtained from our website www.cogg.ie or from the [Department of Education and Youth](#).

3. Irish Language

As Irish is the administrative language of the organisation, it is preferable but not essential that Tenderers have the capability to deliver the service through both the Irish as well as the English language. COGG will provide advice and support in this regard to the successful Tenderer. This website should be bi-lingual (Irish and English). No automated translation services (Google Translate, WPLM etc) to be used.

4. Contracting and Tendering

The project will deliver a fully functional resource website with a launch date of August 2027. COGG will award a 3-year contract, (1 year to develop + 2 years to maintain) subject to annual review or unless otherwise terminated. **The budget is 75,000 Euro (VAT inclusive)**

COGG reserves the right to extend the term for a period or periods of up to 1 year, with a maximum of one such extension or extensions on the same terms and conditions.

Tender documents must be submitted by **close of business on Monday 24th August**.

Tenders that are late will not be considered.

5. Accessibility, Optimisation and Cookies

The website must be compliant with WCAG 2.1 AA (or equivalent) and need to pass annual inspection by the National Disability Authority (NDA).

The website should be optimized for mobile phones, tablets i.e. device agnostic.

If cookies are in use then standard accept and decline options and bi-lingual options should be made available for the users.

6. Access and Training

Full back-end access must be provided to COGG as well as training for technical and non-technical users within COGG. Continuous support for the duration of the contract must be provided.

7. Queries, Clarifications and Costs

All queries or requests for clarification relating to any aspect of this public procurement competition or of this RFT must be directed to the Questions and Answers facility on www.etenders.gov.ie. Queries or requests for clarifications will be accepted no later than **close of business on Monday August 24th** unless otherwise published by COGG.

All clarifications and responses to queries/requests for clarification will be responded to through the additional information facility of www.etenders.gov.ie. Where appropriate, questions may be amalgamated. Tenderers may also submit queries by emailing eolas@cogg.ie. Due to annual leave over the summer months additional time may be required to respond.

COGG reserves the right to issue or seek written clarifications.

COGG reserves the right to update or alter the information contained in this document at any time up to **six** days before the final date for receipt of Tenders. Participating Tenderers will be so informed through the eTenders website. In the event of such updates or alterations COGG reserves the right to postpone the deadline for the receipt of Tenders so as to allow Tenderers sufficient time to respond.

All costs and expenses incurred by Tenderers relating to their participation in this public procurement competition including, but not being limited to, site visits, field trials, demonstrations and/or presentations shall be borne by and are a matter for discharge by the Tenderers exclusively.

The Tenderers are required to contact COGG via e-mail (eolas@cogg.ie) if they decide to withdraw from the public procurement process.

8. Confidentiality and Freedom of Information

All documentation, data, statistics, drawings, information, patterns, samples or material disclosed or furnished by COGG to Tenderers during the course of this public procurement competition:

- are furnished for the sole purpose of replying to this RFT only;
- may not be used, communicated, reproduced or published for any other purpose without the prior written permission from COGG;
- shall be treated as confidential by the Tenderer and by any third parties (including subcontractors) engaged or consulted by the Tenderer; and
- must be returned immediately to COGG upon cancellation or completion of this public procurement competition if so requested by COGG.

Tenderers should be aware that, under the Freedom of Information Act 2014, information provided by them during this public procurement competition may be liable to be disclosed. Tenderers are asked to consider if any of the information supplied by them in their Tender should not be disclosed because of its confidentiality or commercial sensitivity.

If Tenderers consider that certain information is not to be disclosed because of its confidentiality or commercial sensitivity, Tenderers must, when providing such information, clearly identify such information and specify the reasons for its confidentiality or commercial sensitivity. If Tenderers do not identify information as confidential or commercially sensitive, it is liable to be released in response to a Freedom of Information request without further notice to or consultation with the Tenderer.

COGG will, where possible, consult with Tenderers about confidentiality or commercially sensitive information so identified before making a decision on a request received under the Freedom of Information Act.

9. Pricing

Budget: 75,000 Euro

All Tenderers must complete the Pricing Schedule at Appendix 2 to this RFT.

All prices quoted must be all-inclusive (i.e. including but not being limited to all costs/expenses/indexation), be expressed in Euro only and inclusive of VAT. The VAT rate(s) where applicable should be indicated separately.

Tenderers must confirm that all prices quoted in the tender will remain valid for 12 months commencing from the closing date for the receipt of tenders.

Any currency variations occurring over the term of the Services Contract shall be borne by the Tenderer.

Payments for Services provided pursuant to this RFT shall be subject to and be made in accordance with the Services Contract.

10. Insurance

The successful Tenderer shall be required to hold for the term of the Services Contract the following insurances –

- Employer's Liability
- Public Liability
- Professional Indemnity

By signing the Tenderer's Statement at Appendix 3, tenderers confirm, that if awarded a contract under this public procurement competition, they will, from the Effective Date of the Services Contract (as defined in the Services Contract), obtain and hold the types and levels of insurance as specified above. The successful tenderer will, during the Services Contract, be required to advise COGG of any change to its insurance, produce proof of current premiums paid upon request and produce valid certificates of insurance upon request.

11. Award Criteria and Contracts

The contract will be awarded on the basis of the most economically advantageous tender.

COGG will apply the following award criteria: most economically advantageous compliant tender taking into account the following award criteria and weightings:

Criteria	Weightings	Max. Marks	Minimum Score Required
Methodology – Description of approach to the project including a project plan with key milestones and contingencies	30%	3000	1800
Experience – Previous developments in similar sectors or areas	20%	2000	1200
Proposed Cost	30%	3000	1800
Irish language experience	10%	1000	600
Innovation – Any other aspects which the tenderer could bring to the project that have not been outlined in Appendix A	10%	1000	600

Tenderers may be required to make a presentation of the proposal contained in their tender. It is essential that the key stakeholders and all personnel assigned to this tender should be present at this meeting, either face to face or online.

On a voluntary basis COGG undertakes that no contract can or will be executed or take effect until at least fourteen (14) calendar days after the day on which the unsuccessful Tenderers have been sent the appropriate notice

informing them of the result of this public procurement competition ("Standstill Period"). The preferred bidder will be notified of the decision of the Contracting Authority and of the expiry date of the Standstill Period.

Tenderers should note that the COGG may, when notifying unsuccessful Tenderers of the results of this public procurement competition, include the scores obtained by the Tenderer concerned and the scores obtained by the preferred bidder in respect of each award criterion assessed by the COGG.

The successful Tenderer must sign and return the Services Contract and the Confidentiality Agreement, both in duplicate, to the Contracting Authority no later than 7 seven calendar days from the date of expiry of the Standstill Period unless notified otherwise in writing. Please note that COGG cannot and will not enter into a contract until the Standstill Period has expired. A signed Services Contract returned by the successful Tenderer is not binding on COGG until COGG has signed the Services Contract.

Where the signed Services Contract and the Confidentiality Agreement have not been received by the COGG within 7 calendar days then COGG may proceed to award the contract to the next highest-ranked Tenderer.

If, following the award of this contract, the successful tenderer cannot, for whatever reason, deliver the required services to the satisfaction of COGG; then COGG reserves the right to award the contract to the next highest-ranked tenderer emerging from this competitive process at any time during the tender validity period. This shall be without prejudice to the right of COGG to terminate the contract and commence a new competitive process.

APPENDIX 1 – PROJECT REQUIREMENTS AND SPECIFICATIONS

Specification Document: An Tobar – Irish Language Educational Platform

- **1. Project Overview**

Project Title:

An Tobar – Irish Language Educational Platform

Purpose:

To design and develop a dynamic, scalable educational website supporting the teaching and learning of Irish (Gaeilge) in English-medium primary and post-primary schools.

The platform will provide structured, curriculum-aligned resources for:

- Students
- Teachers
- Parents/guardians

- **2. Core Design Principles**

- Fully editable and scalable (admin-configurable)

- Clear separation between **Primary (Bunscoil)** and **Secondary (Iar-bhunscoil)** experiences
 - Strong emphasis on:
 - Searchability
 - Structured navigation
 - Multimedia learning resources
 - Age-appropriate design (child-friendly vs teenager-oriented UI)
-

- **3. Homepage Specification (Main Landing Page)**

3.1 Header Section

- Large banner displaying: **“An Tobar”**
 - Colours: *To be confirmed*
 - Top-right corner:
 - Social media icons (clickable links)
-

3.2 Navigation Tabs

Default tab names:

- Baile
- Nuacht
- Acmhainní an Tobair
- Comórtais
- Tobghaeltacht
- Padlet COGG

Requirement:

- Tabs must be:
 - Fully editable
 - Renamable
 - Addable/removable

- Reorderable
-

3.3 Search Engine & Filter System

Placement:

- Left-hand side under navigation tabs

Features:

- Open search text box
- Advanced filtering system / keywords

Results display control:

- User can select:
 - View all results
 - View 10 / 20 / 100 results

Initial Filter Categories:

- User Type:
 - Parent
 - Teacher
 - Learner
- Content Type:
 - Resources
 - Training
 - Language Classes

If “Resources” Selected:

Additional filters:

- School Level:
 - Bunscoil (Primary)
 - Iarbhunscoil (Secondary)
- Level / Year Group

- Topic
- Resource Type

✓ **Requirement:**

- All filters must be:
 - Editable
 - Addable/removable
 - Configurable over time
-

3.4 Primary Navigation Buttons

- Two large buttons:
 - **Primary Resources (left)**
 - **Secondary Resources (right)**
-

3.5 Additional Homepage Elements

- News section
 - Links to external organisations/resources
 - Footer:
 - COGG information
 - Social media links
-

4. Primary Resources Section (Bunscoil)

4.1 Design Reference

Based on provided layout ([Canva reference](#))

4.2 Navigation Tabs

Default:

- Baile

- Treoir an Mhúinteora
- Acmhainní
- Suaitheantas na gCarachtar
- Cúinne na bPáistí

☒ Fully editable (rename/add/remove)

4.3 Homepage Layout (Primary Section)

Slider

- Positioned below tabs
 - Default: 3 slides
 - Editable content (add/remove slides)
-

4.4 Search & Filter System

Located on left side under tabs.

Filters:

Class Level:

- Naíonáin Shóisearacha
- Naíonáin Shinsearacha
- Rang a hAon
- Rang a Dó
- Rang a Trí
- Rang a Ceathair
- Rang a Cúig
- Rang a Sé

Themes:

- Mé Féin
- Ar Scoil

- Caitheamh Aimsire
- An Aimsir
- Bia
- Éadaí
- Ócáidí Speisialta
- An Teilifís
- Ag Siopadóireacht
- Sa Bhaile

Topics:

- Multiple topics per theme (expandable)

Resource Types:

- Pictures
- Videos
- Sound files
- PowerPoint
- Worksheets
- Word Document
- PDF

Additional filters:

- Assessment
- Planning

☒ All filters must be dynamic and editable.

4.5 Additional Search Features

- Result limits: (All / 10 / 20 / 100)
 - Related searches / related topics suggestions
-

4.6 “Treoir an Mhúinteora” Section

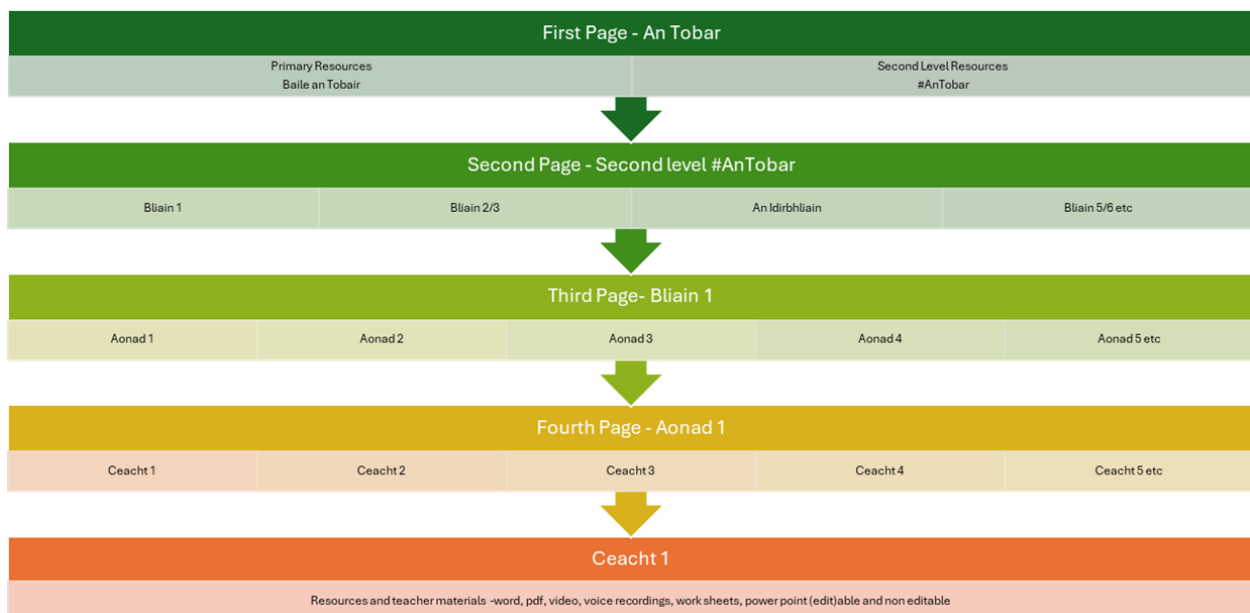
- Opens:
 - E-book or PDF viewer/download

4.7 Content Area

- Structured resource repository (expandable)
-

5. Secondary Resources Section (Tobshaol)

- **5.1 General Design**
- Title: #Tobshaol
- Visuals:
 - More modern / “edgy” aesthetic
 - Aimed at teenagers
 - Distinct colour palette



-
- **5.2 Navigation Tabs**

Default:

- Baile
- Nuacht
- Acmhainní an Tobair
- Comórtais
- Tobghaeltacht

☒ Fully editable

- **5.3 Search & Filters**

Same structure as homepage, with these filters:

Year Groups:

- Bliain 1
- Bliain 2/3
- Idirbhliain
- Bliain 5/6

Topics:

Examples:

- Is Gael Mé
- Mo Shaol ar Scoil
- Mo Shaol Sóisialta
- M'áit chónaithe

Resource Types:

- PPT
- Word Document
- Posters
- Worksheets

☒ Fully editable filter system

- **5.4 Homepage Layout (Secondary Section)**

Buttons Layout

Row 1 (Large Buttons):

- Bliain 1
- Bliain 2/3
- Idirbhliain
- Bliain 5/6

Row 2 (Smaller Buttons):

- Pacáistí tacaíochta
- Pacáistí Uile Scoile
- Tuismitheoirí / Teaghlaigh
- Múinteoirí
- Naisc Eile

☒ Developers must ensure:

- Buttons are fully configurable (add/remove/rename)
-

5.5 Additional Elements

- News feed (right-hand side)
 - Resource spotlight slider (below buttons)
 - Footer (same as homepage)
-

6. Secondary Navigation Structure (Deep Navigation)

- **6.1 Group 2 – By Year Group**

Example: **Bliain 1**

Users see new button set:

- Aonad 1 – Aonad 6
- Pacáistí tacaíochta

- Punann Teanga
- Naisc Eile

☒ Fully editable buttons

- **6.2 Group 2 – Múinteoirí Section**

If “Múinteoirí” selected:

Buttons include:

- Acmhainní don seomra ranga
- Treoir agus tacaíocht
- Pacáistí Uile Scoile
- FGL
- Cúrsaí Gaeilge
- Naisc eile

☒ All buttons dynamic and configurable

- **6.3 Group 3 – Unit Level (e.g. Aonad 1)**

Buttons:

- Ceacht 1 – Ceacht 6
- Aonad Iomlán
- Treoir don mhúinteoir
- Nodbhileoga don Mhúinteoir
- Pacáiste Tacaíochta
- Naisc eile

☒ All editable

- **6.4 Resource Access**

Each item links to content such as:

- PowerPoint files
 - Word documents
 - PDFs
 - Videos
 - Audio files
-

7. Content Management Requirements

Admins must be able to:

- Edit all text and labels
 - Manage tabs and buttons
 - Configure filters and search categories
 - Upload and organise resources
 - Control sliders and featured content
-

8. Technical Requirements

8.1 Platform

- Fully responsive web application
 - Desktop + tablet + mobile compatible
-

8.2 CMS

- User-friendly content management system
 - Non-technical users can update:
 - Content
 - Navigation
 - Filters
-

8.3 Performance

- Fast load times
 - Optimised for school usage
-

8.4 Accessibility

- WCAG compliance recommended
 - Irish language font and character support (síneadh fada)
-

8.5 Security & Compliance

- GDPR compliant (critical)
 - Secure authentication
 - Data protection for minors
-

9. Key Development Requirement (CRITICAL)

Across all sections of the site, the following must be true:

- ☒ Tabs are editable
 - ☒ Buttons are editable
 - ☒ Filters are configurable
 - ☒ Content structure is flexible
 - ☒ Navigation hierarchy can evolve
-

10. Future Enhancements (Optional)

- Gamification (badges, points)
 - Speech/audio interaction
 - Personalised learning pathways
 - LMS integration
 - Mobile app version
-

11. Deliverables

- Fully functional website

- CMS access for administrators
- Documentation
- Deployment-ready system

APPENDIX 2 – PRICING SCHEDULE

THIS FORM OF TENDER MUST BE COMPLETED AND SIGNED BY ALL TENDERERS.

Failure to sign this Form of Tender will invalidate the offer

To:	COGG
From:	
Re:	An Tobar

I/We have examined the tender documentation and hereby offer to provide the services in accordance with the details contained within the Invitation to Tender Document.

Item	Amount (Ex. VAT)	Amount (Inc. VAT)
Cost Year 1		
Cost Year 2		
Cost Year 3		
Total		

I/We confirm that I/we

- We confirm that our rate is inclusive of all related expenses.
- Will keep this offer for the contract open for acceptance by you for a period of 12 months from the date of deadline for submission of tenders;
- Agree that you are not bound to accept the most economically advantageous or any tender you may receive;
- Have read and thoroughly examined the tender document;
- Fully understand the tender document and the Contracting Authority's requirements,
- Undertake to treat the details of this invitation to tender, our tender response and any subsequent clarifications as private and confidential;
- Acknowledge that acceptance by the Contracting Authority of this tender will not constitute a binding and enforceable agreement and that a legally enforceable agreement will not exist until and unless the contract has been established between the Contracting Authority and the tenderer;
- Have availed of all offers for additional information or have otherwise satisfied myself/ourselves as to conditions that may in any manner affect the performance of the services required under the contract;

- Have included all elements necessary for the performance of the contract, which are either expressly stated in the tender document or contained in any supplementary information or which could reasonably be inferred therefrom;
- Have found no errors, omissions, conflicts or ambiguities in the tender document except those which I/we have brought to the attention of the Contracting Authority before the latest date for submitting queries;
- Have included for compliance with all statutory requirements applicable in Ireland and those applicable in any country where parts of the contract may be performed that are in force 7 days prior to the deadline for receipt of tenders;
- Will not, if awarded the contract, employ labour in a manner that is discriminatory in relation to gender, race, religious beliefs, age etc.

Signed:			
Name (in Capital Letters)			
On behalf of:			
Address:			
Email:			
Total		Date:	

APPENDIX 3 – TENDERER'S STATEMENT

TO: **COGG**

RE: An Tobar – Invitation to tender for creation of an educational website to aid the teaching of Irish in English medium primary and post-primary schools

Having examined your Request for Tenders (RFT) including the Instructions to Tenderers, Qualification and Award Criteria, Requirements and Specifications, Terms and Conditions of the Services Contract, we hereby agree and declare the following:

1. We understand the nature and extent of the Services required to be delivered as described in Requirements and Specifications at Appendix 1 to the RFT.
2. We accept all of the Terms and Conditions of the Services Contract, as set out in the RFT, and the Confidentiality Agreement and agree if awarded any contract to execute the Services Contract.
3. We accept all the Qualification and Award Criteria as set out in Part 3 of the RFT and, if requested by the Contracting Authority, shall immediately furnish such evidence as may demonstrate our economic and financial capacity.
4. We agree to provide the Contracting Authority with the Services in accordance with the RFT and our Tender.
5. We confirm that all prices quoted in our Tender will remain valid for the period of time commencing from the closing date for the receipt of Tenders.
6. We shall, if awarded any contract under the RFT, have in place on the Effective Date of the Services Contract all insurances (if any) as required.

Signed:			
Name (in Capital Letters)			
On behalf of:			
Address:			
Email:			
Total		Date:	